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Project A. Generative Creatures

Interaction Day: Mar 3, 2026

Presentation: Mar 10, 2026 Mar 12, 2026

Documentation: Mar 13, 2026

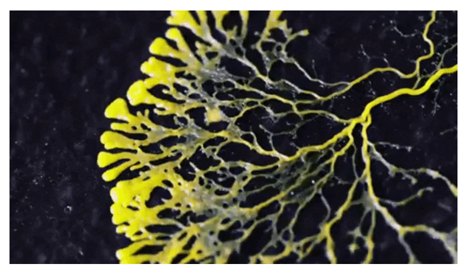
Introduction

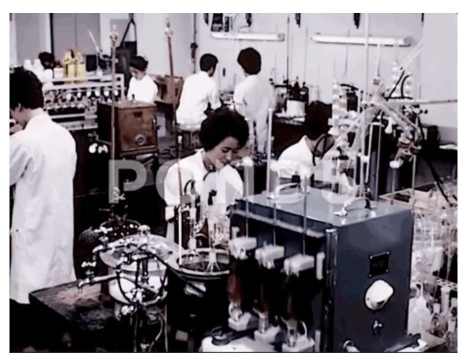
You are a scientist and your quest is **the discovery of new forms of life** in your laboratory.
Your process begins with a single unit/bacteria/creature which – placed on your canvas – comes to life and into motion.

In the next phase, you are using all the equipment at your disposal to animate this creature and **observe as it mutates and develops**. Your expertise is to experiment with its **motion**, increasing its complexity gradually. Its **shape**, too, emerges and it starts to perform reactions to its spectators' **interactions**.

A key discovery is that this creature, whenever growing anew, seems to never look or move exactly the same as prior. It is as if **some of its features generate with a degree of randomness!**

The process of crafting this form of life takes care and takes time; as you do it, your responsibility is to observe and discover the creature's character and **its story – why does it move and look the way it does?** What is its natural habitat, does it eat and if yes, what? **Extend a detailed description** of the creature and present both





to an esteemed audience of other scientists soon!

The assignment

You are asked to make a **generative visual** that evolves based on the conditions you design. The idea of breeding a new form of life *can* be the starting point of your ideation, but does not have to be literal. The visual you create shall **not remain static** – it never looks exactly the same way twice (it's generative) and it **responds visually to our interaction** with it.

Dimension Requirements for your sketch: 800x500pixel `createCanvas(800, 500);`

Requirements

- Attribute references you were inspired by.
- Credit the Creative-Commons licensed sources you used.
- Reminder from CCLAb's syllabus:
  It is important that your code is written by yourself and only uses the concepts and syntax that are part of CCLab's course materials (e.g. you shouldn't use vectors in your code since they were not covered). If you have experience with code or syntax that was not covered in the course, you must consult with your instructor in advance whether you can use it for your project. You must not use ChatGPT or other AI tools for any purpose other than idea generation. **When using these tools, your instructor might not be able to assess your progress in this course, therefore, your grade in the assignment will be an F.**
  Please also review the Creative Coding Lab - Syllabus | Spring 2026

Learning Outcomes

Upon completion of this project, students will be able to:

- use the fundamentals of programming;
- apply comprehensively various methods in p5.js and visualize generative and interactive animations;
- publish a p5.js sketch on the web using Github

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- practice approaches to project management — scoping, project plans, project reviews, and;
- develop and structure a larger-scale project.